AUWA — Business Structure, IP & Legal

Last Updated: 16 April 2026

This file is the single reference for AUWA's corporate structure, intellectual property, trademarks, licensing, domains, and social accounts. Original documents are stored in `Dropbox/3 venture/auwa/admin/`.

CORPORATE ENTITIES

AUWA Limited (IP Holding Company)

Field	Detail
Company No.	17033727
Incorporated	15 February 2026
Status	Dormant (holds IP assets only)
Directors	Rieko Vining, Thomas Vining
Shareholders	Rieko Vining (50%), Thomas Vining (50%)
Registered Address	167-169 Great Portland Street, Fifth Floor, London, England, W1W 5PF
Companies House	View

AUWA Limited owns all AUWA intellectual property and licenses it to More Air Limited for development and operations. Owning IP does not trigger "active" status. File dormant accounts annually (free, 5 minutes).

Activation triggers: Revenue exceeding ~£100k/year, outside investment, major B2B deal, or team expansion. On activation: license novates from More Air to AUWA Limited, domains/handles transfer, More Air becomes development partner.

More Air Limited (Operating Company)

Field	Detail
Company No.	7051794
Incorporated	2009
Status	Active (trading)
Directors	Rieko Vining, Thomas Vining

Shareholders	Rieko Vining (50%), Thomas Vining (50%)
Website	moreair.co

More Air handles all AUWA commercial activity: website, app, store, marketing, revenue, and expenses. AUWA is operated under an exclusive worldwide license from AUWA Limited.

How Money Flows

More Air client work funds the founders separately. All AUWA revenue is received by More Air Limited and reinvested into growth. AUWA Limited receives no revenue while dormant. When AUWA becomes profitable, a royalty structure (5-10% of AUWA revenue from More Air to Tom + Rieko personally) should be added. Flagged for accountant review.

More Air pays AUWA-related expenses (trademark filings, domains, hosting) and records these as operational costs.

TEAM

Following the traditional Japanese ukiyo-e model: eshi (artist) + hanmoto (publisher) as equal partnership.

Rieko Maeda, Creator (Eshi): Japanese-born illustrator from Kansai, also known by her artist name Eko. Creator of the AUWA universe (2015 onwards). Native Japanese speaker. 20+ years design and illustration. Leads: character art, seasonal content, figure design, creative direction, Japanese craftsman outreach. (Legal name: Rieko Vining.)

Thomas Vining, Producer (Hanmoto): Design technologist and brand strategist. 20+ years experience (Nokia, Apple, Sky). Built and operated a Japanese multi-merchant platform (2005-2007). Leads: app design and build, brand, business development, marketing, project oversight, store platform and operations.

Capacity: Tuesday to Friday (3-4 day week, 10am-6pm). AUWA gets 60%, More Air 25%, ventures 10%. No work Monday. Health and relationship come before any deadline.

OWNERSHIP CHAIN (IP)

1. Rieko + Tom created all AUWA IP (artwork, stories, name, character) from ~2015 onwards
2. IP assigned from personal names to AUWA Limited via Assignment Agreement (23 February 2026)
3. AUWA Limited licenses IP to More Air Limited for development/operations
4. More Air handles all commercial activity (website, app, store, marketing)

TRADEMARKS

Word Mark: "AUWA" — Batch 1

Field	Detail
Mark	AUWA (word mark)
Application No.	UK00004341028
Filed	15 February 2026
Registry	UK IPO
Classes	9, 16, 20, 41
Priority Date	15 February 2026
Cost	£320
Status	**Advertisement phase** (published for opposition 6 Mar 2026)
Documents	`trademark/2 word mark/application/batch 1/`

Nice Classification:

- **Class 9:** Software, mobile apps, downloadable content
- **Class 16:** Books, printed matter, illustrations
- **Class 20:** Decorative objects, figurines (non-toy)
- **Class 41:** Entertainment, exhibitions, publishing, music services

Expected registration: ~May 2026 (2 months from advertisement date, if no opposition).

Word Mark: "AUWA" — Batch 2

Field	Detail
Mark	AUWA (word mark)
Application No.	UK00004373944
Filed	16 April 2026
Registry	UK IPO
Classes	25, 28, 35
Cost	£325
Owner	Auwa Limited
Documents	`trademark/2 word mark/application/batch 2/`

Nice Classification:

- **Class 25:** Clothing, footwear, headwear, t-shirts, hoodies, sweaters, graphic t-shirts, casual clothing, loungewear, sleepwear, scarves, hats, caps, beanies, socks, clothing featuring artistic illustrations and seasonal designs
- **Class 28:** Toys, games, collectible toys, collectible figures, collectible figurines, vinyl toys, designer toys, art toys, display figurines, decorative toy figures, limited edition collectible figures, blind box toys, character toys, ornamental toy figures, miniature figurines, toy figures featuring illustrated characters
- **Class 35:** Online retail store services relating to wellness software, mobile applications, downloadable digital content, books, illustrated books, printed publications, art prints, posters, calendars, notebooks, stationery, greeting cards, decorative objects, figurines, works of art, ornaments, collectible toys, collectible figures, vinyl toys, designer toys, art toys, clothing, t-shirts, sweatshirts, hoodies, sweaters, jackets, hats, caps, scarves, socks

Combined word mark coverage: Batch 1 + Batch 2 gives AUWA word mark protection across **7 classes** (9, 16, 20, 25, 28, 35, 41) in the UK.

TM3A Amendment — DECLINED

An attempt to add Classes 25, 28, 35 via TM3A form (~23 February 2026, £150) was declined. TM3A only allows transfer of goods between existing classes, not addition of new classes. Fee refunded. This led to the Batch 2 filing above.

Ownership Transfer (TM16)

Field	Detail
Form	TM16
Transfer	From Thomas Vining + Rieko Vining to AUWA Limited
Filed	~24 February 2026
Cost	£50
Status	**Confirmed** (26 February 2026)
Documents	`trademark/2 word mark/ownership/`

Design Mark: AUWA Character

Field	Detail
Mark	AUWA character silhouette (full, with arms)
Application No.	UK00004373930
Filed	16 April 2026
Registry	UK IPO
Classes	20 (decorative objects), 28 (toys)

Cost	£265
Invoice No.	1026117494
Payment Ref	L8PTTUYNSY
Owner	Auwa Limited
Image Format	Black silhouette on white background
Artwork	`trademark/3 design mark/artwork/auwa.ai` and `auwa.png`
Documents	`trademark/3 design mark/application/01-*.pdf`

Filed as standard black-on-white (not colour-specific) following the KAWS precedent, allowing enforcement in any colour variant. Single application for the full character with arms. Simplified "without arms" version deferred unless needed later.

Evidence (Character Creation Dates)

Evidence supporting Rieko's creation of the AUWA character from 2015 onwards, stored in `trademark/3 design mark/evidence/`:

- **artwork/files/** — Original Illustrator files dated 2016-2020
- **artwork/screenshots/** — File property screenshots showing creation dates
- **linkedin/20170710/** — LinkedIn posts from July 2017 showing AUWA character publicly shared
- **gemini/** — Screenshots from AI chat proving character discussion predates filings

Trademark Searches

WIPO Global Brand Database: Clean. No conflicting marks in AUWA's target classes. **Google Image Search:** No conflicting character designs found. **UK IPO:** Keyword search for "AUWA" returned zero results in relevant classes. Screenshots saved in `trademark/3 design mark/search/`.

INTERNATIONAL FILING (Madrid Protocol)

Field	Detail
Deadline	**15 August 2026** (6 months from UK priority date)
Target Jurisdictions	Japan, USA, EU
Classes	9, 16, 20, 41 (from word mark Batch 1). Add 28 if Batch 2 completes in time
Estimated Cost	£650–1,050 (word mark only)
Strategy	Word mark only internationally. Design mark UK-only initially

Word mark provides ~80% of protection at ~30% of the cost. Design mark international filing deferred to Year 2.

Japan: Juno International Conflict

Field	Detail
Existing Mark	"AUWA" registered in Japan by Juno International
Japan Application No.	第6712100号
Juno's Classes	3 (cosmetics), 10 (medical), 14 (jewellery), 18 (leather goods), 25 (clothing)
Overlap with AUWA	**None in core classes**
Documents	`trademark/2 word mark/exclusions/juno-international.txt`

Safe in Japan: App, books, figurines, wooden objects, digital experiences, entertainment, toys/collectibles. **Blocked in Japan:** Tote bags, t-shirts, cosmetics, jewellery (Juno's classes). **Options (deferred):** Contact Juno, challenge for non-use, or negotiate. Japanese IP lawyer ~£1,500-2,000.

Other Conflicts

WashTec (industrial cleaning) owns "AUWA" in their industry. Zero class overlap. Risk of challenge: 5-10%. **Sony** had an expired Class 9 filing (expired 2017). No longer relevant.

COPYRIGHT

Rieko's artwork is automatically protected from moment of creation under the Berne Convention (UK, EU, USA, Japan). No registration required.

Evidence: Illustrator files from 2016 onwards, LinkedIn posts from July 2017, 4 completed illustrated books, Dropbox files with modification dates.

Formal registration (not pursued): UK IPO £30, US Copyright Office $65, Chinese registration £100-200. All deferred given the volume of dated evidence already held.

Copyright protects the specific artwork (stops exact copying). Trademark (design mark) protects the character shape as brand identifier (stops commercial use of similar shapes). Both needed for full protection.

LICENSING AGREEMENTS

IP Assignment: Personal to AUWA Limited (Active)

Field	Detail
Date	23 February 2026
Assignors	Rieko Vining + Thomas Vining
Assignee	AUWA Limited (Company No. 17033727)
Consideration	£1 nominal
Covers	UK Trademark UK00004341028, all copyright in AUWA character/illustrations/books/stories, all future IP rights
Document	`trademark/1 license/20260223_auwa_assignment.pdf`

Operating License: AUWA Limited to More Air (Active)

Field	Detail
Date	23 February 2026
Licensor	AUWA Limited (Company No. 17033727)
Licensee	More Air Limited (Company No. 7051794)
Grant	Exclusive, worldwide license to use, develop, and commercialise AUWA character, trademarks, and associated IP
Sublicensing	Permitted (e.g. for hotel B2B)
Consideration	£1 nominal (royalty-free for now)
Termination	30 days written notice by either party
Historical clause	Acknowledges More Air's development since 2017 under verbal agreement
Document	`trademark/1 license/20260223_auwa_license.pdf`

Original License (Superseded)

The first license (14 February 2026, personal to More Air) is superseded by the structure above. Archived in `trademark/1 license/_archive/`.

DOMAINS

Domain	Purpose
auwa.life	Primary (brand home, website)
auwalife.com	Redirect to auwa.life

auwa.app	App (Kokoro Mirror)
auwaapp.com	Redirect to auwa.app
auwa.world	Story/brand universe
auwaworld.com	Redirect
auwa.store	Shop
auwastore.com	Redirect
auwa.co.uk	UK legal protection
auwa.uk	UK legal protection

Registrar: UK2.net (consistent with More Air domains). **Email:** hello@auwa.life (configured), plus platform-specific aliases. **Not available:** auwa.art. **Pre-existing:** auwaworld.com (registered ~2017).

SOCIAL HANDLES

See `context/social.md` for the full, current social account map (handles, logins, status, pending verifications, and outstanding steps). `social.md` is the single source of truth and is updated whenever the social landscape changes.

Summary: one brand, three handle variants by necessity. `@auwalife` is the default, `@auwa.life` is used on TikTok and Bluesky (where dots are permitted and match the domain), `@auwa` on LinkedIn (pure brand name, pre-owned). All accounts route to `social@auwa.life`.

COSTS SUMMARY

Item	Cost	Status
Word mark Batch 1 (Classes 9, 16, 20, 41)	£320	Paid
TM3A amendment (declined)	£150	Paid (refunded)
TM16 ownership transfer	£50	Paid
AUWA Limited incorporation	~£50	Done
Domains (~11)	~£51	Secured
Word mark Batch 2 (Classes 25, 28, 35)	£325	Paid
Design mark UK (Classes 20, 28)	£265	Paid
Total spent	**~£1,061**	

Madrid Protocol (planned)	£650–1,050	Planned
Estimated Year 1 total	**~£1,711–2,111**	

KEY DATES & DEADLINES

Date	Event
15 Feb 2026	AUWA Limited incorporated. Word mark Batch 1 filed (UK00004341028)
23 Feb 2026	IP assignment + license agreements signed
24 Feb 2026	TM16 ownership transfer filed
26 Feb 2026	TM16 confirmed
27 Feb 2026	Word mark Batch 1 examination complete
6 Mar 2026	Word mark Batch 1 enters advertisement (opposition) period
16 Apr 2026	Design mark filed (UK00004373930), Classes 20 + 28
16 Apr 2026	Word mark Batch 2 filed (UK00004373944), Classes 25, 28, 35
~6 May 2026	Expected: Word mark Batch 1 registration (if no opposition)
15 Aug 2026	**DEADLINE: Madrid Protocol filing (6-month priority window)**

OPEN ACTIONS

1. ~~**Design mark filing**~~ — **DONE.** 16 April 2026. UK00004373930. Classes 20 + 28. £265.
2. ~~**Word mark additional classes**~~ — **DONE.** 16 April 2026. UK00004373944. Classes 25, 28, 35. £325.
3. **Madrid Protocol filing** — Word mark in Japan, USA, EU. Must file by **15 August 2026**. Budget £650-1,050. Skip Class 25 in Japan (Juno conflict).
4. **Word mark Batch 1 opposition period** — Monitor for any opposition on UK00004341028. Expected to clear ~May 2026.
5. **Royalty structure** — When AUWA generates revenue, add royalty terms to the More Air license. Accountant review needed.
6. **Social handle registration** — Secure across remaining platforms (see handles table above).

LEGAL PRINCIPLES (Reference)

- **No attorney hired.** All filings done DIY to date.

- **Personal ownership = personal liability.** Corrected by assigning IP to AUWA Limited.
- **Use in commerce requirement:** Must actually use trademark in each registered class within 5 years or risk cancellation for non-use.
- **Paris Convention:** First filing gives 6 months to file in other jurisdictions with the same priority date (15 Feb 2026).
- **Nominal consideration (£1):** Makes agreements legally binding under English contract law.
- **Standard black-on-white design marks** allow enforcement in any colour (KAWS precedent).

KEY CONTACTS

	Detail
Tom Vining, Producer	tom@moreair.co
Rieko Maeda, Creator	rieko@moreair.co
AUWA	hello@auwa.life
More Air	moreair.co
Companies House	AUWA Ltd 17033727, More Air Ltd 7051794

FILE LOCATIONS

All original documents stored in Dropbox:

```
Dropbox/3 venture/auwa/admin/
├── corporation/                        — Company incorporation documents
├── trademark/
│   ├── 1 license/
│   │   ├── _archive/                   — Original (superseded) license
│   │   ├── 20260223_auwa_assignment.*  — IP Assignment: personal → AUWA Ltd
│   │   └── 20260223_auwa_license.*     — Operating license: AUWA Ltd → More Air Ltd
│   ├── 2 word mark/
│   │   ├── application/
│   │   │   ├── batch 1/                — Original 4-class filing + examination + advertisement
│   │   │   └── batch 2/                — Additional 3-class filing (16 Apr 2026)
│   │   ├── exclusions/
│   │   │   ├── juno-international.txt  — Japan conflict analysis
│   │   │   └── wipo-results.png        — WIPO search results
│   │   └── ownership/                  — TM16 transfer to AUWA Ltd
│   └── 3 design mark/
│       ├── application/                — Design mark filing (16 Apr 2026)
```

```
│       ├── artwork/                    — Prepared character silhouettes
│       ├── evidence/                   — Creation date evidence (2016–2020)
│       └── search/                     — WIPO + Google search results
├── costing/                            — Financial planning
├── domains/                            — Domain registration records
└── office/                             — Virtual office details
```